

NILA'S BREATH OF FRESH AIR



When we ask, what is the concept of *ganda*? I always associate beauty with the word, *maaliwalas*. This goes beyond a visual aesthetic—it is rather a felt aesthetic. It's an experience of delight, pleasure, and ease. It's that 'ahh' when you come into a space that is clear and free, open and flowing.

— Aya Maceda, a Brooklyn-based Filipino architect

Maaliwalas is a Tagalog term used to describe an environmental condition characterized by the presence of ample natural light, unrestricted airflow, and an overall sense of spatial openness.

The Breath Between Walls

A *ventanilla* ("little window") is an architectural feature found in the *bahay na bato* of the Philippines during the Spanish colonial period. It refers to the small, operable windows located directly beneath the main, larger Capiz shell windows. At Nila, this principle lives on in every thoughtfully placed opening, every cross-ventilation strategy, every design decision that prioritizes fresh, moving air over sealed enclosure.



HOW NILA EMBRACES THE VENTANILLA

01

CONTINUOUS AIRFLOW

Just as the *ventanilla* allowed air to move, Nila's units are designed with cross-ventilation pathways that keep interiors fresh without relying solely on air conditioning.

02

STRATEGIC WINDOW PLACEMENT

Nila's window and vent placements consider thermal layering: allowing warm air to escape and cooler air to enter.

03

PRIVACY WITHOUT STAGNATION

The *ventanilla*'s genius was allowing ventilation even when privacy was needed. Nila's design includes features that provide the same balance.

04

CONNECTION TO THE BREEZE

Nila's layouts avoid dead-end corners and air traps, ensuring that when the wind blows, the residents feel it.



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